

“All the News  
That’s Fit to Print”

# The New York Times

**THE WEATHER**  
Today, cloudy, humid, showers and a heavy storm, high 72. **Tonight**, humid, rain and a thunderstorm, low 66. **Tomorrow**, cloudy, humid, showers, high 73. Weather map, Page B6.

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Prices in Canada may be higher

\$4.00



OKSANA PARAFENIUK FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

**A Hole in the Heart of Prom**  
Yehor Holodryha, center, danced alone in Kyiv, Ukraine, in memory of his date, Masha, who died in a missile strike in May. Page A6.

## Wartime Sign For Russians: ‘Out of Gas’

**By NATALIYA VASILYEVA**  
ISTANBUL — Alyona Sadovnikova first experienced Russia's gasoline shortages in mid-June, when she pulled into a station and was told it was serving only customers who had ration coupons.  
“I was horrified: Are we in the Soviet Union now where you had to get coupons to buy sausage?” she said in a telephone interview.  
Just a few days later, Ms. Sadovnikova found herself waiting 18 hours to fill up in the city of Irkutsk, in eastern Siberia, almost 3,000 miles from the Ukrainian border.

As Ukraine escalates its attacks on Russian oil infrastructure, including some deep into Russian territory, refineries across the country have been forced to shut down for lengthy repairs.  
That has caused the kinds of gas shortages that many Russian citizens have not seen in their lifetimes. They originally started in Russia-occupied Crimea in May and have since spread to mainland Russia and even Siberia.  
The situation is so serious that Russian officials said last week that they were in talks to explore importing oil from other countries, a startling admission for the world's third-largest oil producer. On Friday, authorities in the Black Sea city of Novorossiysk, home to Russia's largest oil export terminal, said they were suspending gasoline sales to individuals.  
The long gas lines are one of the most vivid and tangible examples

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## Yosemite’s Striking New View: Crushing Crowds

**By SOUMYA KARLAMANGLA**  
YOSEMITE NATIONAL PARK, Calif. — At the base of Yosemite Falls, where white waters roared down a granite cliff, a couple jockeyed through dense crowds to try to take the perfect waterfall selfie. A family of five traded off resting in the single available seat on a wooden bench. A tourist tripped over a toddler, who fell and began wailing.  
There was one spectacle at Yosemite National Park this past weekend not in the glossy brochures: the visitors themselves.  
The crown jewel of the nation's park system, Yosemite is even

### Traffic Jams and Long Lines After Officials Scrap Reservations

more crowded than usual this year, after a decision by the Trump administration to do away with summer reservations here and at other popular parks.  
In the first half of 2026, visitors to and employees of California's regal wilderness park reported hourslong traffic jams, waits at entrance stations and long lines just to purchase a bite to eat.  
Employees of Yosemite and organizations that support it say

that the hordes of visitors are demoralizing staff and damaging the park, as well as its reputation. Many visitors are determined to make the most of their visit, even with long waits. But some travelers have abandoned their plans altogether and driven out of the park's gates after being turned away from every at-capacity major attraction.  
“This is a far cry from the awe-inspiring sights Yosemite is known for,” the state's two U.S. senators, the Democrats Adam Schiff and Alex Padilla, wrote in a letter last week to the administration criticizing the cancellation of Yosemite's reservation system.  
July is already the busiest

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MIKE KAI CHEN FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

The Mist Trail in Yosemite Valley had hordes of hikers Friday. July is national parks' busiest month.

## Trump Asked FIFA to Review U.S. Player’s Ban

**By TYLER PAGER and TARIQ PANJA**  
President Trump called Gianni Infantino, the president of FIFA, in the hours after the United States men's soccer team played Wednesday and asked him to review the suspension of the team's top goal scorer in the World Cup, Folarin Balogun, after he was given a red card, according to four people familiar with the conversation.

### Reversal of Suspension Is Highly Unusual

On Sunday, FIFA reversed the suspension, announcing that Balogun would be eligible to play Monday against Belgium.  
The reversal is highly unusual and is the first time since 1962 that FIFA has allowed a player to appear in a game when they would

have been suspended after being sent off in the World Cup. Infantino has spent years trying to curry favor with Trump. Last year, FIFA created and gave Trump the FIFA Peace Prize amid the president's public, but failed, campaign to win the Nobel Peace Prize.  
Shortly after Balogun's red card, senior Trump administration officials, including Howard Lutnick, the commerce secretary,

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## More Democrats Spoiling for Fight in Midterms

**By TIM BALK**  
With President Trump's second term in full swing and the midterm elections four months away, a new kind of Democratic candidate is ascendant: the outsider vowing to overhaul the system.  
The rise of these candidates shows a mood shift, many in the party say, from the midterms in Mr. Trump's first term. Eight years ago, Democrats won the

### Many Seek Overhaul, Not Just Tweaks

House after elevating scores of candidates calling for good government and incremental health care improvements. This time, many Democratic voters are making clear their hunger for systemic change — charting a course in the first half of the primary sea-

son that could point toward a different type of general election in the fall.  
The party, which has often appeared rudderless since Mr. Trump's return, is testing in real time whether it can go further in key races by running populist progressives who energize the base, or by choosing more traditional, centrist candidates.  
In a marquee Senate race, Democrats picked a fiery, progressive

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**INTERNATIONAL A4-9**  
**Xi Leans on a Longtime Ally**  
Cai Qi, the chief of staff for China's leader, will help refresh the ranks of the Communist Party elite. **PAGE A4**

**Eulogy at a Troubled Mosque**  
The complex that hosted the funeral for Ayatollah Ali Khamenei of Iran is unfinished after nearly 40 years. **PAGE A9**

**BUSINESS B1-5**  
**A.I. Boom Spawns Luxury City**  
Fortunes and birthrates are rising in Hsinchu, the city at the center of Taiwan's chip supply chain and an industry driving the global economy. **PAGE B2**

**A Balm for Tech-Weary Parents**  
A simple audio player for children shows there's still a way to make money while doing something nice. **PAGE B1**

**OBITUARIES A17, 20**  
**A Pioneer in Trans Rights**  
Victoria Cruz was at the Stonewall Inn uprising and was a champion of survivors of violence. She was 79. **PAGE A20**



**NATIONAL A10-16**  
**No Ruining This Birthday Party**  
Storms canceled some Independence Day events, yet Americans still found countless ways to celebrate. **PAGE A14**

**Federal Buildings in Disrepair**  
Decades of deferred maintenance totals \$50 billion. But getting funds from Congress is laborious. **PAGE A16**

**ARTS C1-6**  
**Lending Far More Than Books**  
Libraries across the country are offering American Girl dolls, original artworks, musical instruments and even power tools to help patrons save money and share resources. **PAGE C1**

**Fewer Visitors, More Threats**  
Directors of Jewish museums throughout Europe say they are facing a misconception: that cultural institutions funded by local taxpayers are somehow inextricably linked to Israel. **PAGE C1**

**OPINION A18-19**  
**Roger Rosenblatt** **PAGE A19**

**SPORTS D1-8**  
**5 Years and Vast Fortunes Later**  
Name, image and likeness deals have allowed top-level college athletes to make millions. As long as programs and fans chase wins at any cost, the money will keep flowing. **PAGE D7**

**An Ex-Player Explains It All**  
Andy Roddick, a former Wimbledon finalist now covering the event, doesn't focus just on what's happening. He tells why it's happening. **PAGE D2**

